homes; a raucous mob marching through the streets outside, asserting its ethnoreligious supremacy.

This was the incendiary climate in East Jerusalem, even before Abu Khdair was murdered. Netanyahu tried to calm the situation after his death, urging “all sides not to take the law into their own hands… Israel is a nation of laws for all, and all are compelled to follow the law.” But the riots dragged on for days, steps away from the funeral tent where friends and relatives were holding a vigil. Ahmad Tibi made several appearances, demanding that Israel move quickly to find the killers. “Palestinian blood is no less valuable than the blood of settlers,” he said.

The body was returned to the family on Friday, 4 July, shortly after midday prayers, unceremoniously dropped off in the middle of the street by an ambulance. The funeral march wound down Shuafat’s main street, along the trashed light rail tracks, until it reached a turnoff: the crowd could continue down the main road, toward central Jerusalem, or hang a right towards the cemetery. Most people did the latter. But dozens of local youth tried to continue their march to the Old City, chanting “to Al-Aqsa!” They were blocked by a line of the now-ubiquitous riot police, sparking hours of clashes in which more than forty people were hurt.

It was an absurd and tragic end: mourners banged on the windows of a nearby restaurant, where a group of waiters was setting tables for *iftar*, the meal that breaks the Ramadan fast. They eventually came out with a bucket of sliced onions, an effective remedy for the clouds of tear gas swirling everywhere. A group of pallbearers holding a simple coffin, draped in the Palestinian flag, scurried down the hill, covering their faces against the fumes.

“Gaza is a graveyard”

A crowd gathered after sunset, perhaps 2,000 people chanting about peace, asking the people of Gaza for forgiveness. A line of police separated them from a smaller counter-protest, a uniform sea of blue and white, where right-wing Israelis sang approving slogans like “Gaza is a graveyard”. Both demonstrations had to stop earlier than expected, under police orders, but the ultra-nationalists did not go home. They roamed the streets, searching for “leftists”, pepper-spraying them and beating them with chairs from a nearby cafe.